

6-Month GRC Course – Relaxed Study Plan

This plan is for learners who want to complete the full GRC program at a sustainable pace over about six months. It assumes 2–3 study sessions per week and that you may be working while taking the course. We'll finish the core GRC parts first (foundations, compliance, risk, controls, policies), then move to audits, vendors, and supporting technical knowledge, and finally, the incident/BCP and case studies. Use the GRC Tracking Excel to tick off each lecture as you go.

Month 1 – GRC Foundations and Security Basics

Week 1 – Welcome & context

- Section 1: Course Introduction – Become a GRC Consultant
 - Course Introduction – Launch Your Journey as a GRC Consultant
 - GRC Overview
 - Industry examples (retail, insurance) – optional this week
 - Quiz 1
- Goal: understand what GRC covers and what the role does.

Week 2 – Security for GRC

- Section 2: What GRC Professional Should Know About Information Security and Cybersecurity
 - The Security Objective & CIA Triad
 - Information Security roles and GRC
 - Key Security Terminologies
 - Quiz 2

Week 3 – Threats overview

- Section 3 (part 1): Understanding Security Threats and Cyber Attacks
 - Adversaries and Threat Actors
 - Malware / cyber attacks
 - Social engineering attacks and countermeasures

Week 4 – Finish threats + start security program

- Section 3 (part 2):
 - Web application attacks (high level)
 - Quiz 3

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- Section 4 (start): Managing Security Program and Strategic Alignment
 - Purpose of Security Program
 - Security Goals and Strategy

Month 2 – Governance, Compliance, and Risk (core GRC)

Week 5 – Security governance & roles

- Section 4 (continue):
 - Security Manager Role
 - Security Roles and Responsibilities
 - (KPIs – watch if relevant)
 - Quiz 4

Week 6 – Regulatory landscape

- Section 5: Regulatory Landscape and GRC Role in Compliance
 - Information Security Standards and Frameworks
 - Laws and Regulations that Affect Information Security
 - Privacy Regulation Requirements

Week 7 – Policies and gap analysis

- Section 5 (continue):
 - Privacy Policy and its Components
 - Performing Gap Analysis
 - Quiz 5

Week 8 – Risk management (part 1)

- Section 6 (start): Enterprise Risk Management Process
 - Risk Management Overview
 - Risk Terminologies
 - Risk Identification

Month 3 – Risk (part 2), Controls, and Policies

Week 9 – Risk analysis and response

- Section 6 (continue):
 - Threat Modeling (optional)
 - Risk Analysis
 - Risk Evaluation and Response

Week 10 – Risk reporting + frameworks

- Section 6 (finish):
 - Risk Reporting and Monitoring
 - Risk Management Frameworks (skim)
 - Quiz 6

Week 11 – Security controls

- Section 7: Designing and Selecting Security Controls
 - Understanding Security Controls
 - ITGC – IT General Controls
 - Control Objectives, Compensating Controls, Countermeasures

Week 12 – Layered defenses and control references

- Section 7 (finish):
 - Defence in Depth
 - Security Control Assessment & Control References
 - Quiz 7

Month 4 – Policies, Third-Party, and Auditing

Week 13 – Policy writing and review

- Section 8 (part 1): Writing and Reviewing Effective Policies, Standards, Procedures
 - Policies as Governance Tools
 - Acceptable Use / Physical Security / Clear Desk
 - Internet, Email, Remote Access Policies

Week 14 – Data, access, and AI policies

- Section 8 (part 2):
 - Data Protection / Encryption / Classification Policies
 - User Account / Password / Access Control Policies
 - AI Usage Policy
 - Review Policies, Standards, Procedures
 - Quiz 8

Week 15 – Vendors and people

- Section 9: Third-party and Supply Chain Risk Management & Personnel Security
 - Vendor Management & Contract Requirements
 - Supply Chain Security and Risk Management
 - Personnel / HR Security

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- Security Awareness Program
- Quiz 9

Week 16 – Auditing and assurance

- Section 10: Information System Auditing and Third Party Assurance
 - IS Auditing Overview & Types of Audits
 - Audit Planning & Execution
 - Evidence Collection & Evaluation of Controls
 - Audit Reporting & Documentation
 - SOC Reports (understand the purpose)
 - Quiz 10

Month 5 – Supporting Technical Knowledge for GRC

Week 17 – IT, networks, and databases (overview)

- Section 11: IS, Network and Computing Basics (high level – for GRC conversations)
 - Information Systems Architecture
 - Computing Components & Enterprise Computing
 - Intro to IT Networks, OSI & TCP/IP
 - Quiz 11
- Section 12: Databases for GRC
 - Intro to Databases, Keys, Resiliency, Security
 - Quiz 12

Week 18 – IAM and cloud

- Section 13: IAM
 - IAAA Framework
 - Authorization and Access Control Models
 - AD / LDAP Overview
 - Quiz 13
- Section 14 (start): Virtualization and Cloud Computing
 - Cloud Computing Overview
 - Cloud Deployment & Service Models

Week 19 – Cloud shared responsibility + data security

- Section 14 (finish):
 - Cloud Shared Responsibility Matrix
 - Cloud Advantages and Security
 - Quiz 14
- Section 15 (start): Endpoint and Data and Physical Security

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- Data Lifecycle, Classification, Data Controls

Week 20 – SDLC and ITSM

- Section 15 (finish): DLP, DRM, Physical Security, Quiz 15
- Section 16: Software Development, Secure SDLC and Secure Code (overview)
 - SDLC process, testing, secure coding, DevSecOps
 - Quiz 16
- Section 17 (start): Release, Change, ITSM
 - Change Management Process
 - Configuration Management

Month 6 – IR, BCP/DR, Resiliency, and Case Studies

Week 21 – Finish ITSM and ops topics

- Section 17 (finish):
 - Vulnerability/Patch Management
 - IT Asset Management & NIST SP 1800-5 (skim)
 - ITIL / COBIT (high level)
 - Quiz 17

Week 22 – Incident management and business continuity

- Section 18: Incident Management and Business Continuity
 - Incident Management & Response Plan
 - BIA & Disasters
 - DRP & BCP
 - RTO/RPO & Recovery Strategies
 - Quiz 18

Week 23 – Resiliency and GRC program

- Section 19: Systems Resiliency Aspects (backup, RAID, network redundancy)
 - Quiz 19
- Section 20: GRC Program Management
 - Implementing GRC Strategy
 - GRC Metrics, Dashboards, and Reporting
 - Quiz 20

Week 24 – Case studies & consolidation

- Sections 21–24: GRC Practical Case Studies
 - Pick the ones closest to your industry or current project (vendor breach, access control,

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BCP gaps, GDPR fines...)

- Do quizzes 21–24

- Open your GRC Companion Excel and make sure all Core items are completed.
- Revisit Sections 5, 6, 7, 8, and 10 if you plan to use this for consulting work.

Final Note

This relaxed plan is meant to be finished. If you miss a week, just continue with the next one. Prioritize Core items in the Excel when you are busy, and leave supporting and long case studies for weekends.